

aspect of the phenomenon that has been occurring on a grander scale that subsumes all investments.

Here are some representative clippings from the time, along with EWT's summary from February 1989:

Prices for art, collectibles and memorabilia of all kinds, from paintings to gold coins to Art Deco to baseball cards to classic cars to old records, have experienced a bubble concurrently with those in real estate and the stock market. Its extent is reflected by the collage below. These items should sell for *substantially less* sometime in the 1990s. Drops of over 50% in the top end and as much as 95% in the lower tiers would not be a surprise.

IN UNCERTAIN times like these, when stocks seem to have lost much of their allure, all sorts of alternative investments present themselves: baseball cards, enamel frogs, Hummels, vintage eye cups, hotel towels stolen by famous Canadian pianists. Individuals who have lost their faith in more conventional investments might also turn their attention to old movie posters, which have undergone a substantial appreciation in value in the past 20 years. 6/29/88

Buying spree sends prices soaring

Buying art: An '80s status symbol

It's an art-buying madhouse out there. Impressionist masterpieces and Hockney and Warhol stuff — it's blue-light-special bustle at prices that would gag Tiffany's. 6/20/88

Art dealers see lots of green these days

PRICIEST PAINTING: Van Gogh's *Irises* sold in 1987 for \$53.9 million.

ART IS HOT

Prices for Collectible Automobiles Surge Amid a Wave of Speculation and Nostalgia, Movie Posters Are a Hot Collectors' Item

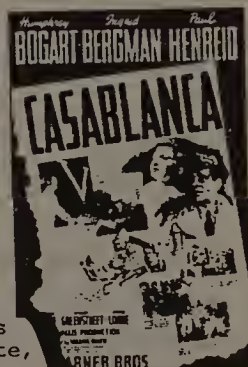
ROCK 'N' ROLL RECORDS:

A HOT NEW COLLECTIBLE

August 3, 1988

Frank Sinatra
IT'S A WONDERFUL LIFE
James Stewart
REED

According to the N.Y. Times and Wall Street Journal classic cars are the hottest investments around, far outperforming real estate, mutual funds, and the stock market. Autos purchased just a few years ago for a couple of thousand dollars are routinely fetching 10 times that at auctions across the country. And this upward trend shows no evidence of stopping.



BARRON'S
September 26, 1988

The rate of increase in general prosperity and financial liquidity peaked in 1989, which is why a number of markets, including aggregate real estate and collectibles, topped out at that time. The latest economic recovery supported bonds into 1993 and has supported stocks into today. Other investments have made room for the selective progress of those markets by lagging significantly. Money is no longer going into all speculative markets, as it did from 1986 to 1989; it is being shifted from one to another. Among the biggest losers in this game so far have been collectibles. Coin prices